

STAYING PUTT: The Trivandrum Golf Club



Nine Hole Handicap

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM The “class war” between the communists and the “bourgeois” sport, golf, shows no respite. But it’s the capitalist sport which seems to win even in Red’s Own Country. The high court has again quashed

the LDF Government’s takeover of the 25-acre, nine-hole Trivandrum Golf Club built by the Travancore royalty in 1890 exclusively for its members, British officials and foreign guests.

Disposing of a writ pe-

tition by the club secretary, the court said the takeover was in violation of principles of natural justice. However, Chief Minister V.S. Achuthanandan is adamant on taking over the club. In June, the Government had acquired the club’s land and its 7,000 sq ft heritage building. These were owned by the government

and were leased out to the club in 1967. The Government contended that the club violated the agreement since it was running a bar and was rented out for weddings and film shoots.

The June takeover following a Cabinet decision was despite a court directive restraining it not to act without observing the formalities. Within hours, the angry court stayed the takeover. The court admonished Revenue Secretary Niveditha Haran for contempt of court and ‘undue haste’ in locking the club. Haran tendered an apology to escape contempt of court.

Opposing Achuthanandan’s bid are the club’s 500-odd members—the elite including civil servants, retired diplomats and businessmen. Achuthanandan clarified that members could continue golfing here after the takeover.

by M. G. Radhakrishnan

THE BUZZ OF THE WEEK

Shivraj Patil did not have to don greasepaint and face TV cameras after last weekend’s bomb blast in Delhi. He was asked to keep mum. Instead, External Affairs Minister Pranab Mukherjee held forth on internal security.

VOICES



“A draconian (anti-terrorism) law is likely to be misused. We are known as one of the best protectors of human rights in the world.”

K.G. Balakrishnan, chief justice of India

“Democracy and dynastic politics cannot go together just as a one-party rule has no place in a democracy.”

L.K. Advani, leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha

“The only achievement of successive governments of the last 10 years has been the creation of such an atmosphere where nobody would trust Muslims.”

H.D. Deve Gowda, former prime minister and JD(s) leader

“I am as old as the prime minister. If he can run the country, why can’t I run a state?”

V.K. Malhotra, BJP’s chief ministerial candidate for Delhi

“This is our homeland. In our homeland, I don’t think anyone can harm us. We are confident that nothing bad will happen. We will be free to move wherever and whenever we want.”

Sachin Tendulkar, cricketer

